

Implementation Methodology

CRCG's Four-Gate Delivery Framework — Version 3.1

Overview

CRCG delivers all multi-month engagements using a common Four-Gate Delivery Framework, regardless of practice area. Each gate represents a formal go/no-go decision point requiring sign-off from both the Engagement Lead and the client executive sponsor before proceeding. The framework was introduced firm-wide in 2021 and most recently refreshed (Version 3.1) in mid-2024 to add explicit data quality checkpoints following lessons learned from the NovaHealth interoperability program.

Gate 1: Discovery & Diagnostic

Establishes current-state baseline, validates engagement assumptions, and confirms scope before design work begins. Typically 10–20% of total engagement duration. Exit criteria require client sign-off on a documented current-state assessment and any scope adjustments identified during discovery.

Gate 2: Design

Produces the future-state design, technical architecture (where applicable), and implementation plan. For Digital & Analytics engagements, this gate includes a mandatory data quality assessment checkpoint, added in Version 3.1 specifically in response to the unplanned data quality remediation required during the NovaHealth program. Exit criteria require client sign-off on the design document.

Gate 3: Build & Pilot

Covers core build activity and a limited-scope pilot (a single plant line, a single store cluster, a single depot, etc.) before broader rollout. Pilot results are formally reviewed against pre-defined success criteria at this gate; engagements may not proceed to Gate 4 without meeting or formally waiving pilot success criteria with client sponsor agreement.

Gate 4: Rollout & Hypercare

Extends the validated pilot solution across the full scope and provides a defined hypercare period (typically 60–90 days) before formal program close-out and capability hand-off.

Gate Exit Criteria Summary

Gate	Typical Duration (% of total)	Required Sign-off	Key Artifact
Gate 1: Discovery & Diagnostic	10–20%	Client Exec Sponsor	Current-State Assessment
Gate 2: Design	15–25%	Client Exec Sponsor + Engagement Lead	Design Document / Architecture
Gate 3: Build & Pilot	35–45%	Client Exec Sponsor	Pilot Results vs. Success Criteria

Gate	Typical Duration (% of total)	Required Sign-off	Key Artifact
Gate 4: Rollout & Hypercare	20–30%	Client Exec Sponsor + Engagement Lead	Final Acceptance Sign-off

Application Across Practice Areas

While the four gates are common across practice areas, the specific artifacts and success criteria are tailored. For example, in the Risk & Compliance practice's Operational Risk Controls Uplift offering, Gate 3 success criteria are typically defined as evidence package completeness against examiner expectations rather than a technical pilot, while in the Digital & Analytics practice's Predictive Analytics offering, Gate 3 success criteria are defined as model precision/recall thresholds agreed in the SOW (for example, the 78% precision threshold defined for the Atlas Manufacturing predictive maintenance pilot, which the model exceeded at 81% precision during the February 2024 mid-point review).

Continuous Improvement

Each engagement closes with a structured retrospective, and findings are aggregated quarterly by the practice leads to inform methodology refreshes. The Version 3.1 data quality checkpoint addition is one example of this feedback loop in action; a further refresh (Version 3.2) is under discussion to formalize change management readiness scoring at Gate 1, informed by lessons from the Helios Energy Phase 2 technician adoption risk (RSK-001).